
'I inexplicably detest Mr Brightside': John Simm's honest playlist

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The first song I fell in love with

My earliest memory is walking into a room at nursery school where they were playing Yellow Submarine by the Beatles. I was captivated by the sound effects, and Lennon shouting: "Full speed ahead!" When it got to the chorus, I remember thinking: "This must be music!"

The first single I bought

When I was eight, I won a competition at school to pick a new record to play at the mini disco we had on Fridays. My teacher took me to Woolworths, and I chose Come Back My Love by [50s revivalists] Darts. The first single I bought with my own pocket money was Mull of Kintyre by Wings from a record shop in Colne in Lancashire. It was No 1 at the time, and I chose it when my dad pointed out that it was by one of the Beatles.

The song I do at karaoke

I honestly cannot stand karaoke and avoid it at all costs. But if I had to, I'd choose Summer Wind by Frank Sinatra.

[embedded content]

The song I inexplicably know every lyric to

I recently realised that I know pretty much all the lyrics to The Boy in the Bubble, You Can Call Me Al, and every song on Graceland by Paul Simon.

The best song to play at a party

It depends what stage of the party you are at. Early doors it would probably be I Heard It Through the Grapevine by Marvin Gaye. As the night wears on, I'd work through Prince, the Stones and Bowie, and when it really kicks off, Phat Planet by Leftfield, Born Slippy .NXXX by Underworld, and Ascension [Nic Fanciulli remix] by Gorillaz featuring Vince Staples, which is an absolute banger.

The song I can no longer listen to

I inexplicably detest Mr Brightside by the Killers.

[embedded content]

The best song to have sex to

Come Together by the Beatles.

The album that changed my life

When I was 12 and starting to learn the guitar, I'd only listen to early rock 'n'roll, and was obsessed with Elvis, Chuck Berry, Jerry Lee Lewis, Fats Domino, Buddy Holly and Eddie Cochran. Then my babysitter brought round Let There Be Rock by AC/DC. It was still rock'n'roll, but it was high voltage rock 'n'roll. As soon as he put the record on the turntable, I was hooked.

The song that gets me up in the morning

What'd I Say parts 1 & 2 by Ray Charles.

[embedded content]

The song that makes me cry

All music makes me emotional. Aretha Franklin, Frank Sinatra, Elvis and the Beatles all make me cry because of the melody and sheer beauty and perfection of the voices. But The Ocean by Richard Hawley gets me going every time.

The song I'd like played at my funeral

Elvis. If I'm cremated, I'll have Burning Love. If I'm buried, I'll have Way Down.

Boston Kickout 30th-anniversary 4K restored version is out now on digital and limited edition 4K/Blu-ray box set.

Produced by wallabag with tcpdf

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